

Queen endings demand perpetual-check awareness

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

Queens can generate checks across large distances, so king safety remains central even with few pawns. Advancing a passer without shelter may allow perpetual check. Exchanging queens can be decisive if the pawn ending is favorable.

WORKED EXAMPLE

You may be a pawn ahead with an advanced passer, yet unable to escape repeated checks. A queen move that offers a favorable exchange or creates a safe king square can be stronger than another pawn push.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you check before forcing a queen exchange?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The resulting king-and-pawn ending: opposition, pawn races, and rook-pawn exceptions. A winning-looking queen trade can lead straight to a drawn or lost pawn ending.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Calculate both the checking defense and the simplified ending.